

don't understand what we should be doing with our finances in the first place. Perhaps that's why so many of us will blindly base our spending decisions on what strangers on the internet are doing or what Karen on Facebook is telling us. In order to develop financial self-reliance we need to choose to trust ourselves. To learn, to read, to discover and work out what's financially right for us—very much like you're doing with this book.

The second and third elements of self-reliance involve understanding how you can develop self-reliance and take action—which Emerson believed are achieved by fostering individuality and resisting conformity through your deliberate actions. He talked about developing intuition, instinct and inner-knowledge, and the courage that this endeavour requires. Because if you're listening to your inner voice, if you're following your inner values and creating a system that's separate from the norm, it may mean operating differently from those around you.

What does self-reliance look like financially? It's the ability to recognise and change your Money Story and your Money Environment to one that is right for you without the influence of others. Sure, you might ask for opinions, educate yourself and even engage professionals, but the ultimate decision you make will be one that follows your financial values. Because you trust yourself enough to take action that is potentially different than society would want for you.

The final tool that will help you create a positive Money Environment is self-control. Remember the marshmallow example and the Dunedin Study? Self-control is rejecting the Money Story that 'I didn't choose to act this way, it just happened to me'. It's creating an environment of systems, distracting habits and accountability for those of us who have naturally low self-control (which if you remember from the research is most of us). We'll look at habits in-depth in Part Three.

Part One of this book has been about identifying your Money Story and Money Environment. I'm hoping that by now you've recognised and identified who or what has influenced your finances up until now and are choosing to rewrite and reform those messages and environments.

Recognising and identifying your Money Story and Money Environment is akin to turning a light on and realising the room isn't how you pictured it and then choosing to reset, dust, redecorate and even in some cases to move to a whole new room. But ultimately, it's about realising you have